

Work Effectively in the GitHub Copilot App

Session 20 | Product and Delivery Teams | Beginner

The app is the classroom

This track does not use Copilot as a background writing tool.

Learners work in the GitHub Copilot app, with repository context and reviewable artifacts.

Know the main work areas

Area	Use it for
Chats	Exploration and interviews
Projects	Repository - grounded work
My work	Issues, pull requests, and sessions
Search	Finding repository information
Automations	Recurring or on - demand tasks
Customize	Skills, agents, MCP servers, and canvases

Context comes before the prompt

Give Copilot the smallest approved context that can answer the question.

Name the files, issues, or repository that should support the answer.

Ask for sources

Explain the initiative for a product owner.
Cite the supplied source for each factual claim.
Mark missing information as unknown.

A confident answer without a source is still unverified.

Inspect what Copilot can use

- Skills provide repeatable procedures.
- Agents carry role-specific instructions and tools.
- MCP servers connect Copilot to systems.
- Canvases provide visible shared state.
- Automations repeat bounded work.

Availability depends on the plan, policy, and installation.

Use one repeatable work pattern

Read -> propose -> review -> write -> verify

Every later Module 7 session uses this pattern.

Conversation should become an artifact

The lab creates a Markdown working brief with:

- facts and sources;
- unknowns;
- useful GitHub artifacts;
- the next decision;
- owner and reviewer.

The artifact must make sense without the chat history.

Lab

1. Open the repository as a Copilot project.
2. Inspect the available capabilities.
3. Question the initiative.
4. Create the working brief.
5. Review the proposed change.
6. Ask Copilot to verify the saved artifact.

Stop if the app or repository context is unavailable.